

2007 Pro-government groups do well in general elections; the opposition Islamic Action Front loses ground.

«150–51 Decline and Fall

Israel



A country created in 1948, fulfilling the Zionist ambition for a Jewish state.

c.990 BCE Jerusalem captured by King David; Israel unified as one nation.

332 BCE Alexander the Great conquers the Persian Empire and takes control of Palestine. Begins Hellenization of area.

63 BCE Jerusalem conquered by Rome.

66–70 CE Jewish revolt against Rome. Fortress of Masada falls in 73 BCE.

1099 Crusaders take Jerusalem after a siege. More than 20,000 Jews and Muslims slaughtered or sold as slaves.

1897 At the Basle Congress in Switzerland, journalist Theodor Herzl defines the aim of Zionism as striving to create Jewish state.

1916 The Sykes–Picot Agreement is signed between Britain and France. Palestine is promised to Britain.

1917 In the Balfour Declaration, the British government agrees to the establishment of a national home for the Jewish people providing that the rights of non-Jews are unaffected.

1920 The San Remo Conference gives the mandate for Palestine to Britain.

1929 Arabs and Jews clash during violent protests in Palestine.

1936 The Arab population of Palestine goes on a six-month strike followed by a large-scale rebellion.

1939 The British government proposes a bill that envisages Palestine as a state in which Arabs and Jews share government.

1942 David Ben-Gurion, chairman of the Jewish Agency Executive, calls for the emigration of Jews to Palestine and the establishment of a Jewish State.

1947 The UN General Assembly adopts a plan for Palestine which divides the country into six parts, with three of the larger parts allocated to the Jews. The Arabs refuse to accept it; clashes follow, and 1,700 people are killed.

1948 Clashes between Arabs and Jews turn into a full-scale war. A provisional Jewish government is established with Ben-Gurion as prime minister. The State of Israel is officially declared, as 400,000 Arabs flee. It is immediately recognized by the US and USSR.

1949 The first general election is held for a single-chamber Knesset (parliament) elected by proportional representation.

1956 President Nasser of Egypt nationalizes the Suez Canal. Israel invades Sinai and Anglo-French forces invade Port Said in Egypt.

1957 Under US pressure, Israeli forces withdraw from the territories invaded in the Suez conflict.

1964 Egypt and other Arab states set up Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO).

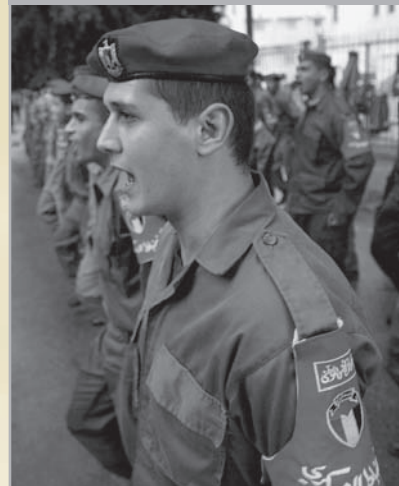
1965 Fatah, the secular political party of the PLO, carries out its first guerrilla action against Israel.

1967 Six-Day War begins with Israel attacking Egypt. Israel takes West Bank, Gaza, Sinai, and Golan Heights.

1968–70 Israel establishes Jewish

DECISIVE MOMENT

PALESTINE AND THE OSLO ACCORDS, 1993



The Oslo agreement, which set up a Palestine National Authority and gave the Palestinians control over a limited portion of Gaza and the West Bank, was signed in Norway in September 1993 and tantalizingly offered the promise of a lasting peace. With little progress made toward reclaiming the territory lost to Israel in 1948, the Arab states in 1964 established the Palestine Liberation Organization as a force to help liberate the Occupied Territories. The PLO—some of whose fighters are depicted here—came to act as a proxy government-in-exile for the Palestinians. Despite a history of violent opposition to Israel, the PLO entered unprecedented talks with Yitzhak Rabin's moderate Labor government in an attempt to negotiate a "land for peace" deal.

settlements in the occupied territories. Yasser Arafat named chairman of PLO.

1973 Egypt and Syria attack Israel. Yom Kippur War ends in victory for Israel.

1977 Egyptian president Anwar Sadat addresses Israeli Knesset (parliament).

1978 Camp David accords with Egypt. Menachim Begin and Sadat sign Israeli–Egyptian Peace Treaty in Washington, DC. Sinai returned to Egypt.

1981 The US sponsors ceasefire between Israel and the PLO that lasts until June 1982. Israel annexes Syria's Golan region.

1982 Israel invades Lebanon.

1987 Palestinians launch first intifada

1995 Prime minister Rabin is murdered in Tel Aviv by an Israeli extremist. He is replaced by Shimon Peres.

1996 First Palestinian elections. Arafat wins. Benjamin Netanyahu (Likud) defeats Peres to become prime minister.

1999 Ehud Barak (Labor) is elected prime minister.

2000 Israeli forces withdraw from southern Lebanon. Violent Israeli–Palestinian clashes begin a second intifada.

2001 Hardliner Ariel Sharon (Likud) is elected prime minister.

2002 Israel reoccupies most Palestinian areas evacuated as part of the Oslo process. Arafat is forced into house arrest. Israel begins construction of a security wall within the West Bank.

2004 Arafat dies in Paris.

2005 Mahmoud Abbas elected President of the Palestinian Authority. Israel evacuates all Israeli settlements in Gaza. Sharon forms new Kadima Party in response to opposition to his plans to withdraw Israeli settlers.

2006 Hamas wins a majority in Palestinian elections. Ehud Olmert (Kadima) becomes prime minister after Sharon suffers a stroke. Israel launches a 34-day war against Hezbollah in Lebanon.

2008 The Winograd commission on the 2006 Lebanon wars finds there were serious failings in the country's leadership. The Israeli army launches a major incursion into the Gaza Strip.

2009 Benjamin Netanyahu, leader of Likud, is elected prime minister.

2010 Israeli armed forces attack a flotilla carrying aid bound for Gaza.

«78–79 Bronze Age Collapse
«200–01 The Crusades
«400–01 The Holocaust
«414–15 The Promised Land

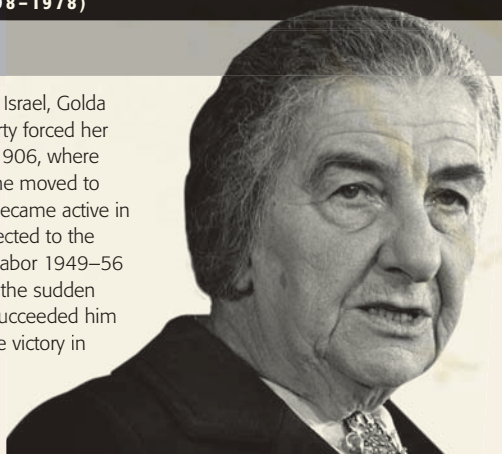
“Israel has created a **new image** of the Jew in the world—the image of... a people that can **fight with heroism.**”

DAVID BEN-GURION

ISRAELI STATESWOMAN (1898–1978)

GOLDA MEIR

One of the founders of the State of Israel, Golda Meir was born in Kiev, Russia. Poverty forced her family to emigrate to Wisconsin in 1906, where Golda became a Zionist. In 1922 she moved to Palestine to live on a kibbutz. She became active in trade union politics before being elected to the Knesset and serving as Minister of Labor 1949–56 and Foreign Minister 1956–66. On the sudden death of Levi Eshkol in 1969, she succeeded him as prime minister at age 70. Despite victory in the Yom Kippur War (1973), she faced internal political squabbles and decided to resign in 1974.



(uprising). Hamas, a hardline, armed Islamist movement, emerges.

1990 Government collapses over proposed negotiations with Palestinians. Influx of Jews from former Soviet Union.

1992 Yitzhak Rabin (Labor) becomes prime minister.

1992 Israel and the PLO sign Declaration of Principles (“Oslo Accords”).

1994 Palestinian autonomy begins in Gaza and Jericho. First Palestinian suicide bombing against Israeli civilians is carried out in response to a massacre of Palestinians at Hebron by an Israeli settler. Israel and Jordan sign peace treaty.